AA-H-00605
June 13, 1960

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

HOUSEHOLD FURNITURE; WOOD; CORRELATED GROUPS OF: MODERN, EARLY AMERICAN, AND RANCH TYPES

This Interim Federal Specification has been prepared by the Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, based upon currently available technical information, and has not been approved as a Federal Specification. It is subject to modification, and pending its promulgation as a regular Federal Specification, may be used in procurement.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. - This specification covers correlated household furniture, intended to be used in matching groups. The supplier may offer other supplemental correlated items not herein requested for consideration by the Government.

1.2 Classifications.

1.2.1 Types, classes and groups. - Unless otherwise specified, the furniture shall be of the types, classes and groups as specified in the invitation for bids.

Type I. - Modern design
- Class A. - American.
  - Group 1. - Bedroom.
  - Group 2. - Dining room.
  - Group 3. - Living room.
- Class B. - Danish Walnut.
  - Group 1. - Bedroom.
  - Group 2. - Dining room.
  - Group 3. - Living room.

Type II. - Early American design
- Class A. - Maple.
  - Group 1. - Bedroom.
  - Group 2. - Dining room.
  - Group 3. - Living room.
- Class B. - Cherry.
  - Group 1. - Bedroom
  - Group 2. - Dining room.
  - Group 3. - Living room.

Type III. - Ranch design
- Class A. - Hard wood.
- Class B. - Soft wood.

FSC 7105

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1.2.2 Design. The design is intended to be commercial, and unless otherwise specified in the invitation for bids, some variations, as to styling, drawer or cabinet arrangement from the sketches supplied will be permitted, provided the general appearance and purpose of the furniture is not adversely affected.

1.2.3 Color of finish. - The color of finish shall be as specified in the invitation for bids and unless otherwise specified shall be the producers commercial color for the color specified.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS

2.1 The following Federal Specifications, Military Specifications and Standards, and other publications, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

AA-H-00600b - Household Furniture, Wood, Casegoods and Chairs and all referenced specifications listed therein.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under "General Information" in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the GSA Regional Office in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Other Publications:

ASTM Specification - D-751-52T - Method of Testing Rubber-Coated Fabrics

(Copies of ASTM Specification may be obtained from American Society for Testing Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia 3, Pennsylvania.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. - Unless otherwise specified preproduction samples as specified in paragraph 3.1 of Interim Federal Specification AA-H-00600b(GSA-FSS) shall be supplied.

3.1.1 Materials. - The materials listed in paragraph 3.1 and subparagraphs thereunder of Interim Federal Specification AA-H-00600b(GSA-FSS) shall apply

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when applicable, and in addition materials listed herein.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 Framing. - The construction requirements of this furniture shall be not less than those specified in paragraphs 3.2.1 through 3.2.11.4 of Interim Federal Specification AA-H-00600b with additions or exceptions specified herein.

3.2.1.1 Open frames of seating pieces. - The open frames of upholstered settees, easy chairs, club chairs, occasional chairs, rockers and sectional pieces shall be of any of the woods listed in column 3, table II of AA-H-00600b, and in addition woods listed herein are acceptable for exposed parts of type III, class B furniture. The base frames for all types shall be not less than 1-1/16 inch thick by not less than 2-3/4 inches wide. Assemblies shall be double-doweled, mortis and tenons, or chuck dowel and glued according to 3.2.1.2 of AA-H-00600b. The base frame shall have glue blocks at each corner secured by screws. Legs, arm stumps, arm rests stretchers and top back rails shall be not less than 3/4 inch thick and of such width as design requires. Each loose back cushion shall be supported by not less than three horizontal or vertical supports.

3.2.1.2 Cushion base. - The cushion base for each single size seat cushion shall be a helical, suspended under tension, platform and shall conform to the following: (1) The cushion support shall be three 20 gage steel bands, 3/4 inch wide running from front to back and crossed by three full length strips from side to side suspended on helicals which shall be fastened to the frame with hanger clips. The bands shall be covered with a sisal pad weighing not less than 3 ounces per square foot, the pad shall then be covered by 8 ounce denim sewn around a 12 gage border wire frame butt welded together; or (2) The base shall be made of one piece 16 ounce white canvas or 17 ounce sheet webbing sewn around a 9 gage border wire frame butt welded together, suspended on 3 inch helicals spaced not more than 6 inches apart secured to the frame by hanger clips. Securing of denim, canvas or sheet webbing to the border wire shall be accomplished without runs or skips; or (3) Rubber webbing 2 inches plus or minus 1/8 inches wide having a breaking strength of not less than 300 pounds and elongation of not less than 35 percent when tested as specified in 4.4 of this specification. The rubber webbing shall be spaced approximately 2-1/2 inches apart or if interwoven not less than 5 strips shall be used for each single size seat cushion. The rubber webbing shall be secured to the base frame with metal clips clinched or vulcanized to the webbing and inserted into slots in the base frame or by an equally secure method.

3.2.1.3 Cushion base for type III items. - The cushion base of type III items shall be of any of the methods specified in 3.2.1.2 or the cushion base may be surpentine or sinuous type springs. The spring base shall be of high carbon spring steel wire and shall be not less than 9 gage, except for barrel chairs which may be 10 gage. There shall be not less than 6 springs single seat items, or less than 10 springs for two seat items, or less than 13 springs for three seat items. The front and back rails may be grooved and the springs hooked over a 5/16 inch dowel, or the front and back rail may have a cleat not less than 1-1/4 inches wide by not less than 3/4 inches thick, screwed

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and glued to the front and back rails to which the springs are secured by spring clips and not less than four rails per clip. The springs shall be anchored to side rails by 15 gage helicals approximately 2 inches long and to each other by 15 gage helicals or links. The springs shall be covered with a rubberized pad covered by 4 ounce denim, or the springs may be covered with wire reinforced burlap and a layer of cotton felt covered with fabric to match the upholstered cushions.

3.2.2 Cushions. - The cushions for seats and backs shall be reversible and spring or latex foam filled as specified in the invitation for bids. The coil springs for seat cushions shall be 3-1/2 inches high, made of 13 gage steel wire, with 12 gage border wire. The springs for back cushions shall be 3 inches high, made of 15 gage steel wire, with 13 gage border wire. The top of the springs shall be not more than 3 inches in diameter and as many coils as possible shall be used for each cushion. All spring, border and helical wire shall be properly tempered to give comfort and durability. The seat cushions shall be incased in 10 ounce burlap and covered with a one inch layer of rubberized grade A hair as specified in 3.1.5.2 of AA-H-00600b, followed by a layer of cotton as specified in 3.1.5.1 of AA-H-00600b. The back cushions shall be made the same way except grade B hair may be used.

3.2.2.1 Molded foam latex cushions. When specified molded foam latex cushions shall be used and shall be not less than 4 inches thick for seats or less than 3 inches thick for backs, and as specified in 3.1.5.3 of AA-H-00600b.

3.2.2.2 Pin-core foam rubber cushions. - Flat or uncrowned cushions may be of pin-core design, being cored from both sides, the pin-cores being not more than 3/16 inch diameter. The cushions shall conform to type I, grade C, medium density of MIL-C-5001. The edges of cushions cut from such material need not be banded with foam rubber. Seat cushions shall be 4 inches thick (Comm. Tol.) and back cushions shall be 3 inches thick (Comm. Tol.).

3.2.2.3 Cushion covers. The cushion covers shall have self-welts sewn around a jute cord. Welts and seams shall be straight and sewn, without skips, twists or blemishes, with matching thread. Cushions shall fit snug and covers shall be well filled out at corners and edges. All covers for foam latex cushions shall be equipped with rust-resistive zippers. Cover material and colors thereof shall be as specified in the invitation for bids.

3.2.3 Casegoods, chairs, tables, beds, etc.

3.2.3.1 Type I, class A. - These groups of furniture shall be constructed of any of the wood specified in table II of AA-H-00600b for the color of finish specified in the invitation for bids.

3.2.3.1.1 Type I, class B. - These groups of furniture shall be constructed of walnut except pecan may be used for solid exposed parts and unexposed parts shall be as listed in table II of AA-H-00600b.

3.2.3.2 Type II, class A. - These groups of furniture shall be constructed of any of the wood shown in table II of AA-H-00600b for maple finish except "cherry" is deleted and "gum and pecan" may be added.

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3.2.3.2.1 Type II, class B. - These groups of furniture shall have all exposed parts of cherry and unexposed parts shall be of any of the woods shown for unexposed parts in table II of AA-H-00600b.

3.2.3.3 Type III, class A. - The class A furniture shall have exposed parts of oak or white ash and unexposed parts shall be as shown in table II of AA-H-00600b.

3.2.3.3.1 Type III, class B. - The dimensions of structural members of type III, class B, furniture shall be greater than the minimum dimensions specified in 3.2.1.1., to maintain durability and design requirements. The lumber, variety of woods, veneer and facings shall include the use of these softwoods, northern, western, southern white pine and sugar pine. The lumber shall be of a grade and quality commonly used in producing this category of furniture and shall be uniformly kiln dried from 5% to 9% moisture content, loose knots, pitch pockets, shakes, mineral streaks or other defects will not be accepted.

3.3 Methods of finishing.

3.3.1 Exposed parts and surfaces. - All surfaces normally exposed to view shall be finish sanded smooth and all corners and edges eased, and thoroughly cleaned, and finished as herein specified. These surfaces except type III class A furniture, which shall be finished as specified in 3.3.1.2, shall be finished in accordance with the materials, coating system and tests specified in Federal Specification TT-L-57. Alternatively, other similar materials and coating systems meeting the tests specified in Federal Specification TT-L-57 will be acceptable. All exposed finishes shall conform to the general requirements of 3.3.1.1 specified herein.

3.3.1.1 General. - Except for pigmented lacquer toner finished, neither the finishing materials nor their application shall cloud the natural grain of the wood. An ultraviolet light absorbing chemical additive may be used in final coats for light or blond finishes. The application of materials, the drying time, sanding, cleaning and rubbing shall be controlled to produce items of smooth, uniform exposed surfaces without blisters, pits, wrinkles, runs, tackiness or more than a trace of orange peel.

3.3.1.2 Finish for type III, class A furniture. - All solid ends, panels, tops, chair seats and chair backs shall be dipped in a marine type penetrating sealer, then let dry before assembling.

3.3.1.2.1 Ranch oak finish. - Furniture prepared as specified in 3.3.1.2 shall be finished by the following method:

1. Sap stain with non-grain raising stain for color match.
2. Seal wet coat non-stearated sealer, let air dry for approximately 30 minutes.
3. Sand with 5/0 stearated paper.
4. Blow off sealer.

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5. Spray first coat water white alcohol resistant lacquer with U.V. filler added, 26% solids, cut one part thinner to 3-1/2 parts lacquer.
6. Spray second coat lacquer. Same as above.
7. Steel wool.
8. Wax with ranch oak wax with spanish whiting.

3.3.1.2.2 Desert tan finish. - Furniture prepared as specified 3.3.1.2 shall be finished by the following method:

1. Sap stain with non-grain raising stain for color match.
2. Wash coat with non-stearated sealer. Air dry.
3. Rub with steel wool.
4. Fill with red filler. Air dry.
5. Seal wet coat non-stearated sealer. Air dry.
6. Sand with 5/0 stearated paper.
7. Spray first coat water white alcohol resistant lacquer with U.V. filler added, 26% solids, cut one part thinner to 3-1/2 parts lacquer.
8. Spray second coat lacquer same as above.
9. Rub with steel wool.
10. Rub with color desert tan wax.

3.3.2 Unexposed parts and surfaces. - All unexposed interior parts and surfaces including the underside of the top, inside of bed rails, drawer interior and exterior surfaces, drawer bearer sections, and drawer guides shall be machined smooth and cleaned. After the furniture has been finished as specified in 3.3.1, the above parts shall be treated by either method 1 or method 2 as specified below:

Method 1, chemical treatment. - These entire surfaces shall be given a moisture-retarding and lubricating treatment. The liquid used shall conform to the requirements of composition B as specified in Interim Federal Specification TT-S-00180(GSA-FSS). The entire surfaces of the unexposed parts of the drawers shall be submerged in the moisture retarding solution for not less than 3 minutes. The drawers shall be allowed to drain before insertion into the furniture cases and all surplus of the solution shall be thoroughly wiped from finished surfaces to insure a clean smooth finish, and free sliding drawer operation.

Alternatively, the solution may be applied by spraying a heavy wet coat, then oven dried for not less than 30 minutes at a temperature of not less than 120 degrees.

Method 2, sealer and lacquer. - The above parts shall receive one coat of lacquer sealer and one coat of clear lacquer. The sealer and lacquer shall be as specified in 3.1.7 of AA-H-00600b. The outside of drawers, drawer bears, shall then be rubbed with wax. The drawer guides shall be rubbed with paraffin.

3.4 Identification marking. - Each item shall be permanently and clearly marked in an inconspicuous place, with the Federal stock number, this specification number, the year of manufacture, and the contractor's or

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manufacturer's name or trademark so that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.5 Workmanship. - The methods of construction, veneering, joining, assembly, and finishing shall be in strict accordance with the minimum requirements of this specification, and referenced specifications and equal in every respect to the manufacturers' regular commercial production. Each item shall be free from any defects that affect the appearance or that might affect the serviceability for the lifetime of the furniture.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Sampling for inspection. - Representative random samples shall be selected from the lot in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105.

4.2 Inspection. - The items shall be inspected to determine compliance with this specification as to workmanship, materials, design, details of construction, hardware, finish, marking and packing. Each item shall be subject to inspection and tests at all times and places, to determine compliance with all requirements of this specification, and when practicable, during manufacture. When inspection is made at the place of manufacture, all reasonable facilities and assistance required by the inspectors in the performance of their duty for safe and convenient inspection and tests shall be provided by the contractor without cost to the Government. All inspections and tests by the Government shall be performed in such a manner as not to delay the work unduly.

4.3 Supplier's inspection. - Unless otherwise specified herein, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements prior to the submission of supplies for Government inspection and acceptance. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be maintained by the supplier and made available to the Government for a period of not less than one year after completion of contract or delivery of order.

4.4 Test methods.

4.4.1 Tests as specified in 4.4.2 and 4.4.2.1 of AA-H-00600b shall apply and in addition the following:

4.4.1.1 Breaking strength of rubber webbing. - The specimen to be tested shall be 2 inches wide by 8 inches long. The test shall be in accordance with breaking strength method B (cut strip method) described in ASTM Designation D-751-52T except use 2 inch wide specimen in place of the specified one inch, 2 inch wide jaws in place of the specified jaws, and place the specimen in the machine under and one pound initial load.

4.4.1.2 Ultimate elongation. - Determine ultimate elongation at the same time that breaking strength is determined, using Elongation Method described

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in ASTM Designation D-751-52T except an initial load of one pound is used instead of 6 ounces.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 The requirements specified in section 5 of AA-H-00600b shall apply.

6. NOTES

6.1 The requirements specified in section 6 of AA-H-00600b shall apply.

Notice. - When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility, nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise, as in any manner licensing the holder, or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

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